

The FreedomBox Home Server: A Low-cost, Simple and Secure Digital Services Solution

FreedomBox is an easy-to-use private server that allows even non-experts to install and configure server applications with just a few clicks. It runs on cheap hardware, and requires only a basic Internet connection and power.



FreedomBox is based on the motto, “Your digital life should not be in the hands of tech companies or governments.”

It is a community project set up to develop, design and promote personal servers running free software for private and personal communications. FreedomBox is a networking appliance designed to allow interfacing with the rest of the Internet under conditions of protected privacy and data security. It hosts applications such as blogs, wikis, websites, social networks, email, Web proxies and a Tor relay, on a device that can replace your Wi-Fi router, so that your data stays with you. FreedomBox was launched in 2010. After years of development, it is now a fixture in universities, villages, and homes throughout the world.

FreedomBox has two components:

- A free software system
- Always-on, inexpensive and power-efficient hardware about the size of a pocket dictionary

Though the aim of this software is to be hardware-neutral, it specifically supports about ten hardware models. All the supported hardware models are single-board computers that provide the computing power of a smartphone. The software system is 100 per cent free, open source and hence is available for download at no cost. FreedomBox is preloaded with more than 20 apps and offers features that have been designed to protect your freedom, privacy and user rights.

About the FreedomBox Foundation

Founded in 2011 by Columbia Law School faculty member Professor Eben Moglen, the FreedomBox Foundation is a non-profit organisation with 501(c)(3) status based in New York City. It supports the development of FreedomBox and advocates it throughout

the world. The goal is to make freedom on the Internet reproducible by anyone across the globe.

FreedomBox is a Debian Pure Blend. All applications on it are installed as Debian packages. The FreedomBox project itself distributes its software through Debian repositories. FreedomBox comes with automatic software updates powered by Debian.

FreedomBox is designed to be hardware neutral. Its developers aim for it to be installable on almost any computer hardware. One of the benefits of a Debian Pure Blend is that FreedomBox inherits the diverse hardware compatibility of Debian.

As of April 2019, FreedomBox is packaged in custom operating system images for 11 single-board computers. The preferred open source hardware (OSHW) designs are Olimex A20, OLinuXino Lime or the BeagleBone Black. Closed source boards like the DreamPlug, Cubietruck and the Raspberry Pi are possible options, while more are on the way. There is also a VirtualBox image. FreedomBox can additionally be installed over a clean Debian installation. More about the supported hardware can be found at <https://wiki.debian.org/FreedomBox/Hardware>.

FreedomBox can be used as a private cloud as it can provide services to the computers and mobile devices in your home and to your friends. This includes secure instant messaging and

